

4p's

Product

Price

Place

promotion

Understanding digital marketing

With the growth of the internet, digital marketing has become a central focus for many businesses.

This includes techniques such as:

- Search Engine Optimization (SEO): Optimizing website content to rank higher in search engine results.
- . Content Marketing: Creating valuable content (e.g., blogs, videos, infographics) to attract and engage a target audience.
- . Social Media Marketing: Using platforms like Facebook, Instagram, and Twitter to reach consumers directly.
- . Email Marketing: Sending targeted messages to prospects and customers to nurture relationships and drive conversions.

Tools and techniques for market research

Market research is a critical activity for businesses looking to understand consumer behavior, trends, competition, and the broader industry landscape.

1. Surveys and Questionnaires

- . Description: Surveys and questionnaires are one of the most direct methods to gather data from consumers. They can be administered online, by phone, in person, or through mail.

Tools:

SurveyMonkey

Google Forms

Typeform

Qualtrics

Techniques:

Closed-Ended Questions: Provide respondents with specific options (e.g., yes/no, rating scales).

Open-Ended Questions: Allow respondents to express their thoughts freely.

Likert Scales: Used to measure attitudes or opinions on a scale (e.g., 1 to 5, where 1 is strongly disagree and 5 is strongly agree).

A/B Testing: Presenting two different versions of a product or message to gauge preferences.

2. Focus Groups

Description: A small, diverse group of participants is brought together to discuss a product, service, or concept. The goal is to gain deep qualitative insights into attitudes, feelings, and perceptions.

Tools:

Zoom or Microsoft Teams for virtual focus groups.

FocusGroup.com for organizing and conducting focus groups.

Techniques:

Moderated Discussions: A skilled moderator guides the conversation and ensures that key topics are explored.

Projective Techniques: Techniques like word association, sentence completion, or picture interpretation to encourage deeper responses.

3. Interviews

Description: One-on-one interviews allow for in-depth exploration of specific questions and can be structured or unstructured.

· Tools:

Skype or Zoom for remote interviews.

Otter.ai or Descript for transcribing interviews.

· Techniques:

o Semi-Structured Interviews: Follow a general guide but allow flexibility for the conversation to flow naturally.

Depth Interviews: Used to understand the underlying motivations behind consumer choices or behavior.

4. Observation

· Description: Observing consumer behavior directly in natural settings, such as in-store visits or

online browsing patterns, provides valuable insights into how people interact with products or services.

Tools:

Hotjar or Crazy Egg for tracking user behavior on websites.

Retail Audit Software: Helps monitor shelf placement, pricing, and customer interactions with products.

Techniques:

Ethnographic Research: Immersing in the environment of the consumer to observe behaviors, routines, and cultural factors.

In-Store Observations: Tracking how consumers navigate physical retail spaces, examine products, and make purchase decisions.

5. Social Media Listening & Analytics

Description: Monitoring social media platforms for mentions, sentiments, and trends related to

your brand, competitors, or industry.

Tools:

Hootsuite Insights

Brandwatch

Sprout Social

BuzzSumo for analyzing popular topics and content.

· Techniques:

Sentiment Analysis: Analyzing the tone (positive, negative, neutral) of social media posts about a brand or product.

o Trend Tracking: Identifying emerging trends and patterns in consumer behavior on social media platforms.

6. Competitive Analysis

. Description: Studying competitors in the market to identify their strengths, weaknesses, strategies, and potential opportunities.

Tools:

SEMrush or Ahrefs for analyzing competitors' SEO strategies.

SimilarWeb for web traffic analysis.

SpyFu for competitor ad tracking and keyword strategies.

Techniques:

SWOT Analysis: Analyzing competitors' strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats.

Porter's Five Forces: Examining the competitive dynamics within an industry based on

the power of suppliers, buyers, threat of substitutes, threat of new entrants, and competitive rivalry.

7. Market Segmentation Analysis

- Description: Dividing a broader market into smaller segments based on demographic, psychographic, behavioral, or geographic factors.

- Tools:

 - Google Analytics (to segment audiences based on behavior)

 - o Tableau or Power BI for segmentation analysis through data visualization.

- Techniques:

Demographic Segmentation: Grouping consumers by age, gender, income, education, etc.

Behavioral Segmentation: Grouping consumers based on their behavior (e.g., purchasing habits, brand loyalty).

Psychographic Segmentation: Dividing the market based on lifestyle, values, interests, or personality traits.

8. Data Analytics & Reporting Tools

- Description: Analyzing data through sophisticated tools to derive actionable insights from large datasets.

- Tools:

 - o Google Analytics for web traffic insights.

Tableau, Power BI, or Google Data Studio for data visualization.

SPSS or R for more advanced statistical analysis.

- Techniques:

Descriptive Analytics: Understanding historical data to identify trends.

 - o Predictive Analytics: Using historical data to forecast future trends or behaviors.

Cohort Analysis: Examining the behavior of a specific group of users over time.

9. Trend Analysis and Forecasting

. Description: Analyzing historical data and current trends to predict future market conditions.

Tools:

TrendWatching for global consumer trend analysis.

Google Trends to identify what people are searching for.

Statista for industry-specific trend data.

· Techniques:

Extrapolation: Using past data to predict future trends.

Delphi Method: A structured method of forecasting using a panel of experts.

Analyzing competitors

Analyzing competitors is a key part of strategic planning for any business or project. The process helps you understand the strengths and weaknesses of your competitors, uncover market gaps, and identify opportunities for differentiation. Here's how you can approach competitor analysis:

Direct Competitors: Businesses offering the same or similar products or services in the same market segment.

Indirect Competitors: Companies that offer alternative solutions or products that could fulfill a similar need or solve the same problem.

Emerging Competitors: New companies or start-ups that could potentially disrupt the market.

Tools for Competitor Analysis:

. SEMrush/Ahrefs: For SEO and paid search strategies.

. BuzzSumo: To understand their content strategy and what's performing best.

. SpyFu: To uncover competitors' keyword strategies.

. SimilarWeb: To track traffic and user engagement across different sites.

Social Media Analytics: Tools like Hootsuite, Sprout Social, or Brandwatch can help analyze

competitors' social media activity.

SWOT Analysis

A SWOT analysis is a powerful tool used to assess a company's Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, and Threats. It helps businesses understand their internal and external environment

and aids in strategic decision-making.

. Strengths are the internal attributes that give your business an advantage over competitors.

. Weaknesses are internal factors that place your business at a disadvantage compared to competitors.

. Opportunities are external factors or trends that your business can capitalize on to grow, innovate, or improve its position in the market.

. Threats are external factors that could challenge your business or hinder its performance.

Apple SWOT Analysis			
Strengths		Opportunities	
• Brand recognition • Innovative products • Ease of use		• Expand distribution options • Create new product lines • Technological advancements	
Weaknesses		Threats	
• High prices • Closed ecosystem • Lack of experimentation		• Tough competition • Lawsuits • International Issues	

Task:

Swot analysis for a brand of your choice.

Understanding the marketing funnel

Understanding the marketing funnel is crucial for creating effective marketing strategies that attract, engage, and convert customers. The funnel represents the customer journey from awareness of your brand or product to making a purchase (and ideally, becoming a repeat customer or advocate). It's a visual framework that guides marketers in structuring their campaigns and optimizing each stage of the customer's decision-making process.

What is the Marketing Funnel?

The marketing funnel is often broken into stages, each representing a phase in the customer journey. While different companies or industries may use slightly different terms or structures, the funnel typically follows a broad path of:

1. Awareness
2. Interest
3. Consideration
4. Action
5. Retention / Advocacy



TOFU

MOFU

BOFU

Understanding the marketing funnel

Example of a Marketing Funnel in Action

Product: An online course platform

Awareness: The platform runs a blog and creates educational content about learning new skills online. They use Google Ads to target people searching for online learning solutions.

Interest: A visitor clicks on an ad and lands on the platform's website, where they watch a free webinar about online learning. They sign up for a free email course to learn more.

Consideration: After receiving the email course, the prospect receives an email offering a free trial of the platform. They also see case studies of other students who achieved success with the platform.

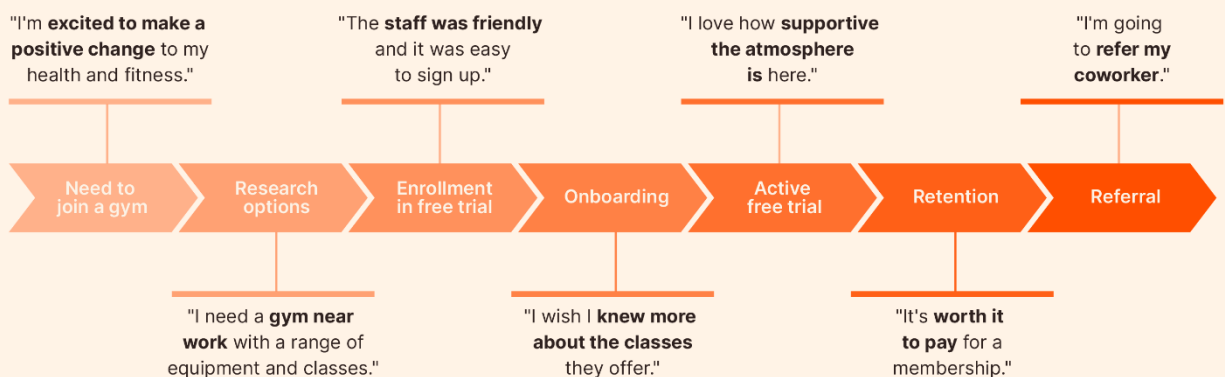
Action: After the free trial ends, the platform sends a targeted offer with a limited-time discount to encourage them to subscribe to a paid plan.

Retention: After they sign up, they receive a welcome email, access to exclusive content, and are invited to join a community of learners. They also receive loyalty rewards after using the platform for several months.

Mapping the customer journey

Mapping the customer journey is a crucial step in understanding how customers interact with your brand from the first point of contact through to post-purchase engagement. It involves visualizing the steps a customer takes, the emotions they experience, and the touchpoints they encounter along the way. This process helps businesses design better experiences, anticipate customer needs, and optimize marketing efforts.

Customer journey map example



Importance of buyer personas

Buyer personas are essential tools in marketing and sales because they provide a detailed, semi-fictional representation of your ideal customers.

These personas are based on real data and insights about your current or target audience, including demographics, behaviors, preferences, challenges, and goals.

Creating and using buyer personas offers several key benefits for businesses:

BUYER'S PERSONA PROFILE



JAKE, 40

DEMOGRAPHICS
Male, Age – 40, lives in Toronto, married with kids. His business currently generates revenue of \$25,000 monthly.

GOALS AND MOTIVATION:
Wants to grow his business so he can give his family a decent life and feel like a responsible father and husband. Also wants to save up and invest enough money to retire before turning 60.

PAIN POINTS:
Struggling to attract steady traffic to his website. Ranks poorly on search engine results pages.

COMMON OBJECTION:
Thinks content marketing cannot attract the kind of traffic he wants.

INTERESTS:
Loves to spend time on Facebook catching up with old friends. Enjoys taking his kids out to the park on weekends.

www.stratwell.ca

Stratwell
Strategic Solutions

Steps to create a buyer persona

To create a buyer persona, follow these steps:

1. **Research:** Gather data from existing customers, surveys, interviews, and analytics. Look at social media, online reviews, and competitor insights.
2. **Identify Demographics:** Determine key details like age, gender, job role, income, location, education, and industry (for B2B).
3. **Analyze Psychographics:** Understand motivations, challenges, interests, values, and goals. What problems do they want to solve?
4. **Study Buying Behavior:** Look at how they research, evaluate, and purchase products. Identify decision-making factors and preferred communication channels.
5. **Create Persona Profiles:** Based on your research, create 1-3 distinct personas. Give each persona a name, job title, background, goals, challenges, and buying habits.
6. **Refine and Update:** Continuously update personas based on new data, feedback, and market changes. Ensure they reflect current customer trends and pain points.

Task

Create a buyer persona for a brand of your choice

. <https://www.hubspot.com/make-my-persona>

. <https://www.semrush.com/persona/>

Key digital marketing terms

Impressions - Total no. of times your ad is seen (not unique)

Reach - Unique no. of times your ad is seen

CPM - Cost per Mile (Mile - 1 Mile = 1000 Impressions)

Clicks- No. of times your ad is clicked on

CPC - Cost per Click = $\text{Total amount spent} / \text{No. Of clicks}$

CTR - Click Through Rate = $\text{clicks} / \text{impression} * 100$

Lead - Potential Client

Conversion - Converted Client

CPA - Cost per Acquisition = $\text{Total amount spent} / \text{No of acquisition}$

CPL - Cost per Lead = $\text{Total amount spent} / \text{No of leads}$

Visit - How many times your page has been visited

LTV - Lifetime Value

A/B Testing - Process of testing two versions

.

PESO Model

The PESO Model is a framework for integrated communication and marketing strategies, originally

developed by Gini Dietrich.

It stands for Paid, Earned, Shared, and Owned media, representing different types of media channels that organizations can use to communicate with their audiences.

This model helps businesses create a balanced, comprehensive approach to content distribution

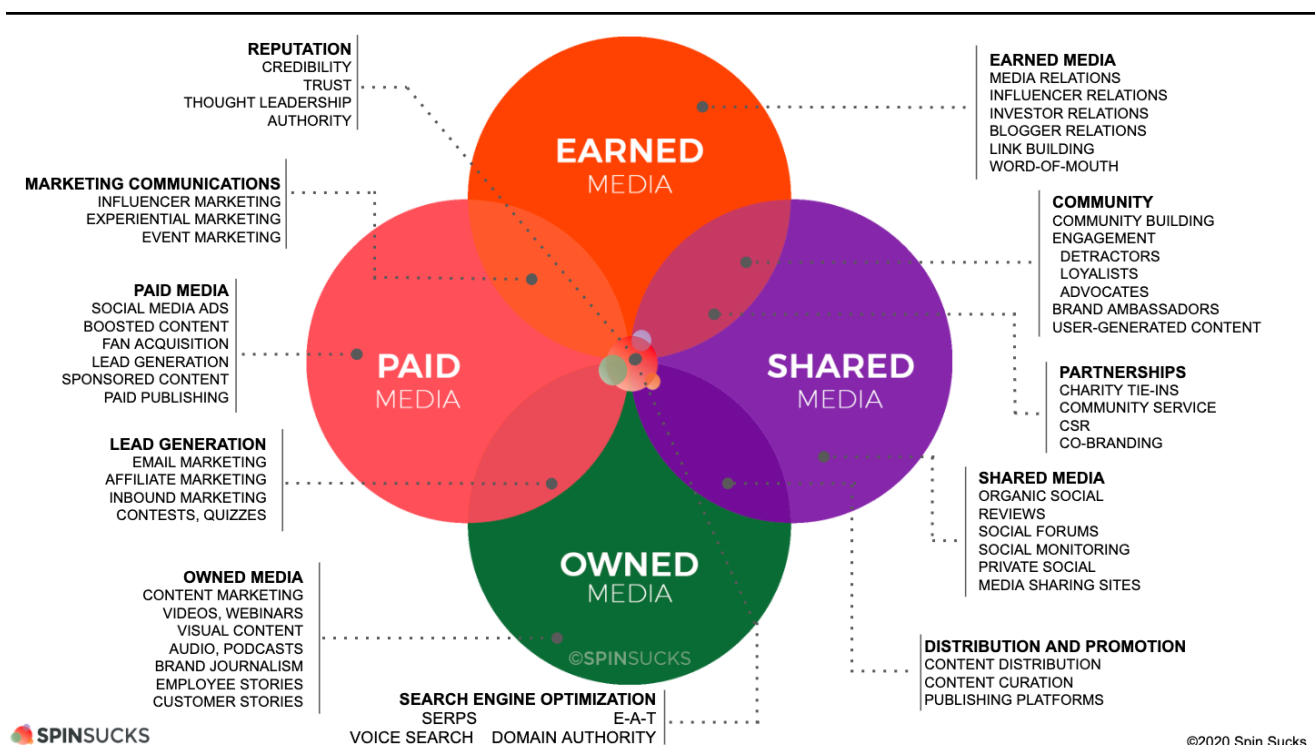
and engagement.

Paid Media - Exchanging money for distribution, whether an ad or content

Earned Media - Trading valuable content for an established authority's audience

Shared Media - Amplifying content through your own audience

Owned Media - Aggregating an audience that seeks you out for content and then distributing your content to that audience



Questions

If your website had 40,656 visitors and 2567 conversions last month, What is your conversion rate? 6.31

Your ad is displayed 17,500 times and If it receives 200 clicks, What's the CTR? 1.14%

Let's say you spent \$1800 on a pay-per-click (PPC) advertising campaign and obtained 40 leads. What's the CPL?

Digital Marketing Basics and Session Overview

Why Digital Marketing Matters

- Wider audience reach (global + local)
- Cost-effective compared to traditional
- Real-time performance tracking
- Targeted campaigns & personalization
- Stronger customer engagement

Digital Marketing Strategy

1. Define Goals & Objectives

- Brand awareness
- Lead generation
- Customer acquisition
- Sales growth
- Customer retention & loyalty

(Example: Generate 500 MQLs in 3 months at <\$40 CPL)

2. Identify Target Audience

- Define Ideal Customer Profile (ICP)
- Segment by demographics, interests, behavior
- Map customer journey (awareness - consideration - decision - loyalty)

3. Competitor & Market Research

- Benchmark competitors' digital presence
- Identify gaps in keywords, content, and ad strategies
- Use tools like SEMrush, Ahrefs, SimilarWeb

4. Channel Strategy

- Owned Media -> Website, blog, email lists
- Earned Media - SEO, PR, influencer mentions, reviews
- Paid Media -> Google Ads, Social Ads, Display, Retargeting

5. Core Digital Tactics

- SEO: Optimize website, content, and technical factors for search visibility
- Content Marketing: Blogs, ebooks, case studies, videos, infographics
- Social Media Marketing: Awareness, community building, engagement campaigns
- Email Marketing: Nurture leads, drip campaigns, customer retention
- Paid Advertising (PPC): Targeted search + display campaigns
- Marketing Automation: Lead scoring, workflows, personalization

6. Measurement & Analytics

- Track KPIs: Traffic, CTR, CPC, CPL, MQLs, SQLs, Pipeline value, ROI
- Use GA4, HubSpot, Looker Studio, CRM dashboards
- Continuous optimization with A/B testing

7. Budget & Resource Allocation

- Define monthly spend for channels (SEO, Paid Ads, Content, Tools)
- Allocate roles: content, performance marketing, analytics, design

8. Continuous Improvement

- Monitor results in real-time
- Double down on high-ROI channels
- Optimize creative, landing pages, and targeting regularly
- Benefits for Business Growth
- Increased brand awareness
- More qualified leads
- Faster sales cycle with remarketing & automation
- Better customer relationships
- Clearer ROI tracking and optimization
- Example Strategy for a Small/Medium Business
- Build a professional, SEO-optimized website.
- Run Google Ads for high-intent keywords (e.g., "best accounting software").
- Publish weekly content (blogs, short videos, guides).

- Engage customers on social media.
- Collect leads via email campaigns with discounts, free trials, or gated content.
- Track performance in analytics dashboards and refine monthly.

Task:

Build a Digital marketing strategy for a business of your choice.

What is Search Engine?

Google YAHOO!

Yandex AOL. Ask.com

Baidu 百度 Bing

How Search Engine Works?

1.Crawling

Definition: Crawling is the process by which search engines discover new and updated pages on the web.

Crawlers/Bots: Search engines use automated programs known as crawlers or bots (e.g., Googlebot) to browse the internet.

Discovery: Crawlers follow links from known pages to discover new content. They also use sitemaps submitted by website

owners to find and index pages.

2. Indexing

Definition: Indexing is the process of storing and organizing the information gathered during crawling.

Content Analysis: The search engine analyzes the content of pages, including text, images, and metadata, and stores

this information in a massive database called an index.

Relevance: The index is designed to make it easier and faster for the search engine to retrieve and rank content based on

users' queries.

3. Ranking

Definition: Ranking is the process of determining the order in which pages appear in search results.

Algorithms: Search engines use complex algorithms to evaluate and rank pages based on various factors, including relevance to the search query, quality of content, user experience, and backlinks.

Factors: Some key factors include keyword relevance, page load speed, mobile-friendliness, and authority of the page.

4. Returning Results

Query Processing: When a user enters a query, the search engine processes this query to understand the intent and context.

Retrieving Information: The search engine retrieves relevant pages from its index that best match the user's query.

Displaying Results: The search engine presents the results on a SERP (Search Engine Results Page), often including a

mix of organic listings, paid ads, and other features like snippets or knowledge panels.

5. User Interaction

Feedback Loop: User interactions, such as clicks, dwell time, and bounce rates, provide feedback to search engines. This

feedback helps refine search algorithms and improve future results.

Key Components of Search Engines:

Crawler/Spider: Software that navigates the web and collects information from web pages.

Index: A database of all the content collected by crawlers, organized to facilitate quick retrieval.

Algorithm: A set of rules and calculations used to determine the relevance and ranking of pages based on various factors.

SERP (Search Engine Results Page): The page displayed by the search engine showing the results for a specific query.

Types of Search Engines

Crawler Based - All crawler based search engines use a crawler or bot or spider for crawling and indexing new content to the search database. Eg: Google, Yahoo, etc

Human Powered - Human powered directories also referred as open directory system depends on human based activities for listings. Eg: Just Dial, Sulekha, etc

Hybrid - Hybrid Search Engines use both crawler based and manual indexing for listing the sites in search results. Eg: infospace.com, dogpile.com

Meta - A metasearch engine is a search tool that uses another search engine's data to produce its own results from the Internet. Eg: DuckDuckGo, Unbubble, etc

SEO vs SEM

Aspect	SEO	SEM
Cost	Free clicks (investment in time & content)	Paid clicks (PPC campaigns)
Timeline	Long-term, gradual results	Instant visibility when ads run
Sustainability	Compounding benefits	Ends when budget stops
CTR & Trust	Higher trust, organic credibility	Higher visibility, ad label shown
Best Use Case	Building authority, long-term traffic	Quick traffic, testing, promotions

Uses of Search Engine Algorithm

1. Information Retrieval

- The primary use is to fetch the most relevant information from billions of web pages.
- Algorithms decide which pages to show and in what order when a user types a query.

2. Ranking Websites

- Search engines rank results based on many factors (keywords, backlinks, site quality, freshness, etc.).
- This ensures that the most useful and trustworthy pages appear at the top.

3. Filtering & Spam Detection

- Algorithms remove low-quality, duplicate, or spammy sites.
- Helps prevent manipulation (like keyword stuffing or link farms).

4. Personalization

- Search results adapt to user's location, search history, device, and language.
- Example: Searching "best restaurants near me" will show local results.

5. Content Understanding

- Algorithms analyze not just keywords but also context and intent.
- For example, a search for "apple" could mean the fruit or the company - algorithms decide based on context.

6. Improving User Experience

- They ensure results are fast, relevant, mobile-friendly, and secure (e.g., preferring HTTPS websites).
- They also power features like snippets, knowledge panels, and "People Also Ask".

7. Ad Placement

- Algorithms also decide when and where ads appear in search results.
- Ensures ads are shown to users with the highest likelihood of engagement.

8. Voice & Visual Search

- Modern algorithms process queries from voice assistants and image searches.
- Example: "Show me red shoes like this" -> Google Lens uses algorithms to match images.

Overview of Google updates

1. Core Algorithm Updates

- Google's core algorithm updates are significant changes that affect how search results are ranked across the board. They're typically broad and can have substantial impacts on search visibility.
- Example: The August 2023 Core Update improved how Google evaluates the quality and relevance of content. Websites with high-quality, well-researched content often saw improvements in rankings.

2. Panda Updates

- Launched in February 2011, the Panda update aimed to reduce the rankings of low-quality, thin, or duplicate content and reward high-quality, original content.
- Impact: Sites with content deemed low-quality, repetitive, or not useful were penalized, while sites with well-researched, valuable content were favored.

3. Penguin Updates

- First rolled out in April 2012, Penguin targeted sites with spammy link-building practices, such as buying links or participating in link schemes.
- Impact: Sites engaging in manipulative link practices saw penalties, while sites with natural, authoritative link profiles benefited.

status.search.google.com/products/rGHU1u87FJnkP6W2GwMi/history

4. Hummingbird Update

- Launched in August 2013, the Hummingbird update improved Google's ability to understand the intent behind search queries and deliver more relevant results.
- Impact: This update enhanced Google's semantic search capabilities, focusing on delivering results based on the meaning of words rather than just individual keywords.

5. Mobilegeddon

- Introduced in April 2015, Mobilegeddon prioritized mobile-friendly websites in mobile search results, reflecting the growing importance of mobile usability.
- Impact: Websites not optimized for mobile devices saw a drop in mobile search rankings, emphasizing the need for responsive design.

6. RankBrain

Rolled out in October 2015, RankBrain is part of Google's core algorithm that uses machine learning to better understand and interpret search queries.

Impact: RankBrain helps Google handle complex queries and deliver more relevant results, focusing on improving the understanding of user intent.

Impact of algorithm updates

Search Rankings

Positive Impact:

- **Enhanced Visibility:** Sites that align well with the new criteria of an update may see improved rankings. For example, a focus on content quality might boost sites with valuable, well-researched content.
- **Increased Traffic:** Higher rankings can lead to more organic traffic, as your site becomes more visible in search results.

Negative Impact:

- **Ranking Drops:** Sites that do not meet the updated standards may experience a drop in rankings. For instance, sites with
- outdated SEO practices or low-quality content might see declines if the update emphasizes higher-quality content.

Web:

<https://www.semrush.com/sensor/>

Keyword Research and The Different types of SEO's

What Are Keywords?

Keywords are words or phrases that people type into search engines (like Google, Bing, or YouTube) to find information. They represent the intent of a search query and act as the bridge between what users are looking for and the content businesses or websites provide.

Examples:

- "best interior designers in Chennai"
- "YouTube rank tracker"
- "digital marketing strategy for ecommerce"

Uses of Keywords

Search Engine Optimization (SEO):

- Keywords help websites rank on search engines.
- By placing relevant keywords in titles, meta descriptions, headers, and content, websites can attract organic traffic.

Content Strategy:

- Keywords reveal what users are searching for, guiding blog posts, videos, landing pages, and FAQs.
- Example: If many people search "how to track YouTube ranking," it signals a strong content opportunity.

Paid Advertising (Google Ads, LinkedIn Ads):

- Advertisers bid on keywords to show their ads to users searching those terms.
- High-intent keywords (like "FedEx shipping refunds software") can bring leads closer to purchase.

Market Research & Trend Analysis:

- Keywords show what's trending and where demand exists.
- Tools like Google Trends or SEMrush reveal how interest in certain keywords changes over time.

Keyword Research & Keyword Mapping

Keyword research is the process of finding and analyzing the search terms that people enter into search engines. It helps you understand what your target audience is searching for and how to create content that matches their intent.

Keyword mapping is the process of assigning researched keywords to specific pages on your website. Instead of stuffing many keywords into one page, you map each keyword (or group of related ones) to the right page to cover intent and avoid cannibalization.

Example:

- Homepage - "Interior designers in India" (broad keyword)
- /interior-designers/chennai -+ "Interior designers in Chennai" (city-specific keyword)
- Blog "How to choose the best interior designer for your home" (informational keyword)

Keyword Research Process

Brainstorm seed keywords (your product/service, industry terms).

Use tools like Google Keyword Planner, SEMrush, Ahrefs, Ubersuggest, or even ChatGPT for ideas.

Check competitors' keywords (see what they rank for).

Analyze search intent (Informational, Navigational, Transactional, Commercial).

Prioritize by metrics:

- Search volume
- Keyword difficulty (competition)
- CPC (if running ads)
- Relevance to your business

Keyword Mapping Process

- List all target keywords (primary + secondary).
- Categorize by intent & topic clusters (group similar keywords).
- Assign one primary keyword per page (plus related variations).
- Map supporting content (blogs, FAQs) to long-tail queries.
- Build a keyword map sheet

Why They Matter Together

- **Research** → Finds the opportunities (what to rank for).
- **Mapping** → Ensures each keyword has a clear home on your site (what page should rank).
- **Outcome:** Better rankings, no keyword cannibalization, improved user experience, higher conversions.

Basics of SEO

- Keyword Research
- On-Page SEO
- Technical SEO
- Off-Page SEO
- Competitor Analysis
- Content Strategy
- Analytics and Monitoring
- User Experience (UX)

Task

Do a KW research for atleast 2 pages for your website

Module - 4

On Page SEO Key Factors

- Meta Tags
- URL Optimization
- Website Content
- Content Optimization
- Image Optimization / Alt Tag
- Keywords & Types
- Heading Tags
- Duplicate Content
- Social Media Integration
- Internal & External Links

What is On Page SEO ?

On-page SEO is also known as on-site SEO. It refers to the practice of optimizing web pages to improve a website's search engine rankings and earn organic traffic.

It also means making sure your website has a high level of quality, rich, relevant content, and trustworthiness.

Why On Page SEO is Important ?

- On-page SEO is important because it helps search engines understand your website and its content, as well as identify whether it is relevant to a searcher's query.

What Google Focus on ?

- Understanding what users are actually searching for when they type a query.
- Delivering search results that meet user intent (informational, shopping, navigational).

What SERP Contains for SEO?



Title Tag

A title tag is an HTML element that specifies the title of a web page. Title tags are displayed on search engine results pages (SERPs) as the clickable headline for a given result, and are important for usability, SEO, and social sharing. The title tag of a web page is meant to be an accurate and concise description of a page's content.

```
<head>
```

```
<title>Example Title</title>
```

```
</head>
```

Google typically displays the first 50-70 characters of a title tag. If you keep your titles under 60 characters, research suggests that you can expect about 90% of your titles to display properly. There's no exact character limit, because characters can vary in width and Google's display titles max out (currently) at 600 pixels.

Visibility of Title tags

Search engine result pages

Web browsers

Social networks

Title Best Practices

- Don't stuff keywords in title
- Give every page unique title
- Add important keywords first
- Take advantage of your brand
- Write for your customers

Why won't Google use my title tag?

- Your title is keyword-stuffed
- Your title doesn't match the query
- You have an alternate title
- You have an old DMOZ listing
- That said, missing, duplicate, and poorly written title tags can all negatively impact your
- SEO results, so make sure you're optimizing for this element.

Writing a Perfect Title Tag

Keyword (Arranged based on volume)

- Digital Marketing Courses
- Digital Marketing Training
- Digital Marketing Training Institute
- Digital Marketing Certification
- Learn Digital Marketing

Writing Titles

- **Digital Marketing Courses | Digital Marketing Training Institute**

Writing title with exact keywords, use when competition is very high

- **Learn Digital Marketing Courses | Training Institute | Certification**

Writing title this way makes it include all different keywords

- **Learn Digital Marketing Courses by Best Training Institute | Certification**

Writing title this way is user friendly and can increase clicks which will eventually increase your ranking

Increase CTR by Using Proper Title

Numbers

Eg: Best 20 Digital Marketing Institute in Chennai

How to Stop 54% of the Users from Exiting your Website

Dates

Eg: How to grow SEO Traffic in 2019 for a fresh website

Become a online marketing expert in 2019 and get placed

Length

With shortened the title tags has measurable increase in rankings

Synonyms

Eg: Keywords is "cheap taxis". People may be looking for "affordable cabs" or "quick taxi" or "cheap ride" So title tag might be "Fast Affordable Cabs, Quick Taxi, Your Cheap Ride."

That's optimized for like three different things within that 50 to 60 word limit, and it's going to hit all those variants and you can actually rank a little higher for using that.

Call to Action

Using words like "buy, find download, search, listen, watch, learn, access, etc" makes user click more on the link as it says what they can do or get by clicking on the links.

Top Referring Keywords (LSI)

Lets take an example of the tool Followerwonk. People may search it as "Twitter search," "Search Twitter Bios," and "Twitter Analytics." So we can write a title like:

"Search Twitter Bios with Followerwonk, the Twitter Analytics Tool."

Questions

Including questions in title tag will be very helpful and as a bonus will increase the chances for you to appear in "featured snippet"

"How to rank at position 1 on Google?"

Tools for Title Tag

<https://poofnewsales.com/tools/title-tag-generator/>

Fetch the Title Search Engine Detects

<https://www.riveronline.com/title-tag-optimizer>

SERP Preview

SEO Minion Chrome Extension

<https://smartsearchmarketing.com/google-title-tag-serp-preview-tool>

Title Code Generator

<https://metatags.io/>

Get Title Idea

What Are Meta Tags?

Meta tags are snippets of text that describe a page's content; the meta tags don't appear on the page itself, but only in the page's code. We all know tags from blog culture, and meta tags are more or less the same thing, little content descriptors that help tell search engines what a web page is about.

Do Meta Tags Help SEO?

Yes, they do, but not all of them and not all of the time. One of the goals of this page is to explain which meta tags help you to get the word out and which have become passe. (See Know Your Meta Tags below).

If you want to find out whether a given page is using meta tags, just right-click anywhere on the page and select "View Page Source".

Meta Description

The meta description is an HTML attribute that provides a brief summary of a web page. Search engines such as Google often display the meta description-typically up to 160 characters long-in search results where they can highly influence user click-through rates.

```
<head>
```

```
<meta name="description" content="This is an example of a  
meta description. This will often show up in search results.">
```

```
</head>
```

Meta descriptions can be any length, but Google generally truncates snippets to ~155-160 characters.

It's best to keep meta descriptions long enough that they're sufficiently descriptive, so it's recommend descriptions between 50-160 characters.

Importance of Meta Description

Google announced in September of 2009 that neither meta descriptions nor meta keywords factor into Google's ranking algorithms for web search.

Meta descriptions can however impact a page's CTR (click-through-rate) on Google which can positively impact a page's ability to rank.

A page's meta description should intelligently (read: in a natural, active, non-spammy way) employ the keywords that page is targeting, but also create a compelling description that a searcher will want to click. It should be directly relevant to the page it describes, and unique from the descriptions for other pages.

Visibility of Meta Deceptions

Search engine result pages

Ctrl + U & in code find meta description

Description Best Practices

Write compelling copy

Avoid duplicate meta description tags

Don't include double quotation marks

Use inverted pyramid technique

Sometimes it's okay to not write meta descriptions (Eg: wikipedia.org)

Why won't Google use my Description Tag?

In some cases, search engines may overrule the meta description a webmaster has specified in the HTML of a page. Precisely when this will happen is unpredictable, but it often occurs when Google doesn't think the existing meta description adequately answers a user's query and identifies a snippet from the target page that better matches a searcher's query.

Tools for Meta Description

Fetch the Description Search Engine Detects

<https://www.riveronline.com/title-tag-optimizer>

SERP Preview

SEO Minion Chrome Extension

<https://smartsearchmarketing.com/google-title-tag-serp-preview-tool>

Description Code Generator

<https://www.coderseo.com/meta-description-generator>

SEO Pro Extension

OFF PAGE SEO

Off Page Optimization

Off Page optimization refers to all the measures that can be taken outside of the actual website in order to improve its position in search rankings. These are measures that help create as many high-quality backlinks (incoming links) as possible.

Purpose of creating a backlink

The purpose of creating a backlink is mainly to improve a website's search engine visibility, credibility, and referral traffic. Here are the key reasons:

1. Boost Search Engine Rankings

Backlinks act as a "vote of confidence" from one website to another.

Search engines (like Google) see backlinks as signals that your content is valuable, trustworthy, and relevant.

More high-quality backlinks usually mean better chances of ranking higher in search results.

2. Increase Referral Traffic

. A backlink is also a direct pathway for users on another site to visit your website.

If the backlink comes from a high-traffic, relevant site, you can get a steady stream of targeted visitors.

3. Build Authority and Trust

. Being mentioned or linked by authoritative websites in your niche improves your Domain Authority (DA) and

brand reputation.

- . Users are more likely to trust your site if they see it referenced by respected sources.

4. Faster Indexing

Backlinks help search engine bots discover your new pages more quickly.

When bots crawl other sites linking to you, they find your pages faster and add them to the index.

5. Networking & Partnerships

- . Link building often involves building relationships with other websites, blogs, and businesses in your industry.

- . This can lead to guest posting opportunities, collaborations, and even partnerships.

Types of Links

1. "Natural" editorial links

Essentially, these are the links that you didn't even have to ask for because they are editorially given by other website owners. This is much more efficient than having to contact someone and ask them to link to you. However, you need to give someone a good reason to do so, and you need to find ways of making large numbers of bloggers aware of that reason.

An example of a good reason may be a great piece of content that you've created which you then seeded with a few key influential bloggers, and through that process more bloggers have naturally become aware of it. This is hard to do and can take time, which is part of why these types of links are so highly valued. They are also the types of links that Google often hold up as great examples, indicating that they will stand the test of time.

2. Manual "outreach" link building

This is probably one of the most common types of link-building you'll perform as an SEO, particularly if you're just starting out or your business is still quite small and unknown. It involves manually contacting website owners and bloggers, asking them to link to you.

Again, you need to give them a reason to link to you and to be successful, you need to be contacting people who are relevant. If you're contacting people who have no connection to your industry, then they are likely to be confused when you ask for a link.

3. Self-created, non-editorial links

This type of link is generally frowned upon these days, as it often falls in line with black-hat practices that aim to fool the search engines into thinking a piece of content is relevant and important when it actually isn't. With the introduction of Penguin in 2012 (and the subsequent updates to it), Google has begun devaluing and even penalizing this type of link. Due to these links not being editorially given, they inherently carry less weight than the other types of links. In the past, they have been useful for some SEOs working on certain websites, but you should use great caution in their implementation now.

A few examples may be:

- . Blog comments that are not moderated
- . Press releases with optimized anchor text

- Article directories

How does a Link Building Technique Work?

At its core, link building is about getting other websites to link back to yours in ways that improve your search

rankings, authority, and traffic. The process usually follows these steps:

1. Identify Link Opportunities

- . Research websites relevant to your niche or industry.
- . Look for sites with good Domain Authority (DA), trustworthiness, and engaged audiences.
- . Example: If you run an Interior Design platform, you'd target home décor blogs, architecture magazines, or furniture marketplaces.

2. Create or Choose Link-Worthy Content

- . People only link to content that adds value.

Types of "linkable assets" include:

Guides, tutorials, case studies

Infographics, data reports, research

Interactive tools (calculators, checklists)

- . Example: A "2025 Interior Design Trends Report" could naturally attract links from blogs and news sites.

3. Outreach & Relationship Building

Reach out to site owners, editors, or influencers to ask for a backlink.

- This can be done via:

Guest posting (writing an article for them with your link inside)

Broken link building (finding dead links on their site and suggesting your resource)

Skyscraper technique (create a better version of popular content and pitch it)

- . Personalization is key-generic emails rarely work.

4. Placement of the Link

- . Once the site agrees, they place your backlink inside a relevant context.
- . Example: A blog about "Best SEO Tools" might link to VideoRankTracker as a recommendation.
- . The anchor text (the clickable words) is important-it signals to Google what your page is about.

5. SEO Value & Results

- . Search engines crawl that backlink and see it as a vote of confidence.
- . The stronger the site that links to you, the more authority (aka "link juice") gets passed.
- . Over time, this:

Improves your keyword rankings

Drives referral traffic

Builds brand credibility

Example of a Link Building Technique in Action

Let's take Guest Posting:

- You find a popular marketing blog.
- Pitch them an article idea (e.g., "How AI is Changing Video SEO").
- Write the article and include a natural backlink to your site.
- Blog publishes it -+ Google sees the link -+ Your site's authority improves -+ You get referral traffic.

Different Types of Off Page Submission techniques

1. Directory Submission

- . Listing your website in online directories under relevant categories.
- Example: Local directories (JustDial, YellowPages) or niche ones (Clutch for SaaS).
- . Purpose: Increases visibility + local SEO signals.

2. Social Bookmarking Submission

- . Sharing your web pages on social bookmarking platforms.
- . Examples: Reddit, Mix, Slashdot, StumbleUpon alternatives.
- Purpose: Drives referral traffic and helps faster indexing.

3. Article Submission

- . Writing long-form content and submitting it to content-sharing sites.
- Examples: Medium, HubPages, EzineArticles.
- . Purpose: Backlinks + audience building.